

Broderick J. DeBettignies

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EDUCATION

Ph.D., Political Science, University of Iowa 2027 (anticipated)

Fields: American Politics, Comparative Politics, Public Policy

Dissertation: "Representation and Morality Policy in the United States"

Committee: Tracy Osborn (Chair), Frederick Boehmke, Eric Hansen, Caroline Tolbert

M.A., Political Science, University of Iowa 2023

B.A. (High Distinction), Political Science and Religious Studies, University of Iowa 2014

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

American Politics, Public Opinion, State Politics, Gender and Politics, LGBT Politics, Representation, Public Policy and Administration, Media and Politics

UNDER REVIEW

DeBettignies, Broderick J. and Abbie L. Eastman. "Adjusting the Thermostat: Anti-Transgender Policies and Feelings of Warmth."

DeRagon, Samantha, **Broderick J. DeBettignies**, and Caroline Tolbert. "Reevaluating the Gender Gap in Voter Turnout in U.S. Elections."

WORKING PAPERS

DeBettignies, Broderick J. "Policy Opinion Diversity Among LGBT Americans: A Theory of Gender-Affirming Opinion Expression."

Boatright, Robert G., Caroline Tolbert, and **Broderick J. DeBettignies**. "Who are the New Republican Voters? Measuring Change in New Primary Voters, 2022 and 2024."

Osborn, Tracy, Anna Mahoney, **Broderick J. DeBettignies**, Taylor Tokos, and Olive Kuester. "Party Power: Understanding Women State Legislators' Institutional Power in the United States."

DeBettignies, Broderick J. and Samantha DeRagon. "Women or Democratic Women?: Examining the Partisan Gender Gap in U.S. Elections."

IN PROGRESS

DeBettignies, Broderick J. "The Diffusion and Adoption of State-Level Transgender Policy."

DeBettignies, Broderick J. "Moral Entrepreneurs as Political Actors."

DeBettignies, Broderick J., Samantha DeRagon, and Tracy Osborn. "The Gender Knowledge Gap in a Polarized Era."

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

“Policy Opinion Diversity Among LGBT Americans: A Theory of Gender-Affirming Opinion Expression”

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, September 2026, Boston, MA

“Who are the New Republican Voters? Measuring Change in New Primary Voters, 2022 and 2024”

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, September 2026, Boston, MA

“Adjusting the Thermostat: Anti-Transgender Policies and Feelings of Warmth”

State Politics and Policy Conference, June 2026, Chicago, IL

“Party Power: Understanding Women State Legislators’ Institutional Power in the United States”

European Conference on Politics and Gender, June 2026, Newcastle, United Kingdom

“Public Opinion, Social Constructions, and Morality Policy Adoption: An Examination of State-Level Anti-Transgender Policy”

State Politics and Policy Conference, May 2025, Boston, MA

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record:

Podcasts, Pop Culture, and Politics	Fall 2026
Careers in Political Science and International Relations	Spring 2026
International Politics of Environmental Issues	Summer 2025
Public Opinion	Spring 2025
Social Media and Politics	Spring 2022; Summer 2024; Fall 2024
The Presidency	Spring 2023
Introduction to American Foreign Policy	Spring 2023

Teaching Assistant:

Introduction to American Politics	Spring 2026; Fall 2025; Fall 2021
US Congress	Spring 2024
Introduction to the Politics of Race	Fall 2023
American Public Policy	Fall 2022
Introduction to Political Thought and Action	Spring 2022

Other Teaching Experience:

Grader, American Government, OnRamps at University of Texas at Austin	Fall 2026–Spring 2027
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RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant Fall 2026
Continuing work with Caroline Tolbert using administrative voter data (Catalist) to examine voter turnout and political behavior. Collaborating on a project using county-level same-sex couple Census data to examine differences associated with LGBT population density.

Research Assistant Spring 2026
Worked with Caroline Tolbert using administrative voter data (Catalist) to assist with co-authored projects with Robert Boatright and Todd Donovan examining voter turnout in primary and general elections. Assisted with research conducted in partnership with Unite America, a nonprofit, nonpartisan organization focused on election reform.

Research Assistant Summer 2023
Worked with Tracy Osborn to collect information on women candidate recruitment groups and develop a survey instrument for candidate recruitment organizations.

Research Assistant	Summer 2023
Worked with Frederick Boehmke on updates to the State Policy Innovation and Diffusion (SPID) database.	
Research Assistant	Summer 2022
Worked with Brian Lai to update the online course catalog, including substantive revisions to the State and Local Politics course.	

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

Political Science Department Travel Funding Grant (\$1,250)	2026–2027
Political Science Department Summer Fellowship (\$5,500)	Summer 2026
Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award (\$1,000)	2026
Tom Carsey Fellowship (\$300)	2026
Political Science Department Travel Funding Grant (\$1,400)	2025–2026
Graduate Teaching Fellowship (\$1,500)	2025–2026
Graduate College Presentation Travel Funds Award (\$480)	2025
Tom Carsey Fellowship (\$300)	2025
Political Science Department Travel Funding Grant (\$1,700)	2024–2025

MEDIA APPEARANCES

Featured in “Iowa Course Examines Social Media’s Influence on Politics,” *For Iowa Magazine*.
 Quoted in Emma Ruby, “Online Influencers Could Help Bring Young People to Politics, But Can Also Cause Harm,” *Dallas Observer*, February 13, 2026.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Session Leader , Center for Teaching New TA Orientation	Aug 2026; Aug 2025; Aug 2024
Lead Facilitator , Political Science TA Training	Fall 2025
First-Year Orientation Team Member , Political Science Department	Fall 2025